

DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT

# The Crescent Compact

A Comprehensive Framework for  
Middle East Regional Stability

**Version 3.1** — Calibrated for the  
Late May 2026 Negotiation Environment

Principal Parties: Iran, United States, Israel, Lebanon,  
Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Syria, Yemen

Guarantors: Qatar, Pakistan, Oman, UN Neutral Chair

*Surgical Refinements Applied: JHTA Sovereignty Recalibration / Day 7 Dual-Trigger / HEU Phase 1 Baseline /  
Lebanon Dossier Isolation Firewall / **Lebanon Dual-Key Escalation Lock***

Late May 2026 | Authorized Negotiators Only

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# C O N T E N T S

The Compact Philosophy

**Part I: Iran–US Nuclear, Military & Economic Normalization**

- I-1: Permanent Cessation of Hostilities (FURC/FURP)
- I-2: Non-Proliferation Framework & Nuclear Dignity (v3.1 HEU Decoupling)
- I-3: Enrichment Suspension & Fordow Conversion
- I-4: Return of Frozen Sovereign Assets
- I-5: Phased Sanctions Relief
- I-6: Iranian Energy Reintegration
- I-7: Regional Security Dialogue & Proxy Wind-Down
- I-8: Strait of Hormuz & Maritime Corridor (v3.1)

**Part II: Israel–Lebanon–Hezbollah Security Architecture**

**Part III: Joint Compact Commission & Dispute Architecture**

**Part IV: Israel–Arab Normalization (Progressive Arch)**

**Part V: Yemen & Red Sea–Hormuz Maritime Security**

**Part VI: Iraq Stabilization & Militia Integration**

**Part VII: Syria De-escalation & Reconstruction**

**Part VIII: Regional Economic Integration & Arms Control**

**Annex K: Lebanon Dossier Isolation Firewall & Core Accord Protection Protocol (v3.1)**

Version 3.1 Changelog

# The Compact Philosophy

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VERSION 3.1 — FOUR SURGICAL REFINEMENTS INTEGRATED — LATE MAY 2026

The Middle East has never lacked for grand bargains. What it has lacked is durable architecture. The Crescent Compact is engineered on three governing principles: **Granular Reciprocity** — every obligation is paired with a benefit of equal political value delivered on the same timeline; **Low-Probability High-Impact Event Absorption** — every mechanism is stress-tested against worst-case scenarios; and **The Crescent Cycle** — progress measured in 60-day verified cycles where all parties complete one small, reversible step before the next window opens.

The Compact consists of a Core Frame (Parts I–III) — minimally sufficient to stop active hostilities and establish nuclear non-proliferation — and Progressive Arches (Parts IV–VIII) that unlock only when Core Frame benchmarks are verified over multiple cycles. The Layered Legitimacy Architecture (LLA) allows governments to ratify the Core Frame without committing to any Progressive Arch.

## v3.1 Critical Update — Late May 2026 Negotiation Environment

This Version 3.1 incorporates four surgical refinements calibrated to the explicit pushback from the IRGC (via Fars News Agency) and the firm sequencing demands from the Trump administration:

- 1. IMCA Sovereignty Recalibration (I-8, V-2):** The IMCA mandate is explicitly restricted to commercial traffic coordination, maritime safety protocols, and international dispute resolution. The PGSA is formally recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters — allowing Tehran to preserve its domestic sovereignty claims.
- 2. Automated Day 7 Dual-Trigger Protocol (I-8):** The Hormuz Opening Declaration and Naval Blockade Lift Declaration are executed through an automated, simultaneous trigger — preventing front-loaded concessions and guaranteeing symmetric execution within a 60-second UTC window.
- 3. HEU Custody Phase 1 Baseline (I-2):** Legal title (Central Bank of Iran) is structurally decoupled from physical custody (IAEA-monitored facility). Physical custody transfer is a Phase 1 baseline verification metric; final disposition is deferred to the 30-60 day nuclear negotiating window.

4. **Lebanon Dossier Isolation Firewall (Annex K):** Addresses Iran's demand for an end to the war on all fronts through a Proxy Operational Pause, a binding firewall preventing Lebanon incidents from collapsing the core deal, and a Levant Regional Basket parallel diplomatic track.

## **Legacy Provision — Instrument of State, Not Substitute for It**

The Crescent Compact is a tool of state authority, not a replacement for it. Every mechanism exists to support the judgment of qualified statespeople — not to supplant it. The framework is the instrument. The human beings who deploy it are the authors.

## **Ceremonial Signature Architecture**

Entry into force requires physical, ceremonial, in-person signature by the authorized representative of each Core Frame party. The signing ceremony is: (a) hosted in a neutral state designated by unanimous JCC consent; (b) open to international press; (c) preceded by a joint public statement by each signing party's head of state or foreign minister; (d) recorded in the official UN Treaty Series. No digital-only, proxy, or undisclosed signature is valid.

# Part I: Iran–United States — Nuclear, Military & Economic Normalization

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Part I constitutes the irreducible foundation of the Crescent Compact. Its provisions are mutually conditioning: nuclear verification and sanctions relief proceed in locked tandem. No party may accept economic provisions while deferring security provisions. The 3-3-2-1 structure ensures parity: Iran receives three core political wins; the U.S. receives three core security wins; economic provisions are jointly beneficial.

## I-1: Permanent Cessation of Hostilities & Force-Use Restraint Compact (FURC)

Upon Compact entry into force, all direct and proxy military operations between Iran and the United States permanently cease. This obligation is institutional, not personal: it binds both states as corporate entities, not their current leadership. Successor governments inherit it in full without renegotiation.

**Force-Use Restraint Protocol (FURP):** Once IAEA certifies Iranian compliance with nuclear provisions I-2 through I-3 for two consecutive Crescent Cycles, the U.S. President issues and maintains a Presidential Policy Directive (PPD) establishing U.S. restraint on initiating military operations against Iranian territory absent: (a) verified imminent armed attack under UN Charter Article 51; or (b) JCC determination of material breach.

**FURC Anti-Gaming Lock:** FURC cannot be suspended unilaterally within 18 months of entry into force. After 18 months, 90-day advance notice plus JCC majority vote required. Suspension for 'policy preference' or 'changed administration' is explicitly prohibited.

**Non-Interference Covenant (NIC):** Both parties permanently prohibit: covert financing of opposition with destabilization intent; cyber operations against electoral or governance infrastructure; state-sponsored propaganda campaigns using fabricated evidence, including AI-generated synthetic media (deepfakes); algorithmically amplified disinformation networks targeting electoral infrastructure; fabricated intelligence dossiers; physical sabotage timed to political transitions; support for armed challenges to constitutional authority.

## I-2: Permanent Non-Proliferation Framework & Nuclear Dignity Doctrine (v3.1)

Iran, in a sovereign act codifying its own doctrinal prohibition on nuclear weapons, enacts through the Majlis: (a) domestic legislation criminalizing nuclear weapons development with minimum 20-year penalties; (b) an independent Civilian Nuclear Oversight Council (CNOC) reporting jointly to the Majlis and the IAEA with quarterly public reports and mandatory referral authority; (c) mandatory automatic UNSC referral for any verified fissile-material diversion.

**Iranian Sovereign Right to Peaceful Nuclear Energy — Affirmation (v1.7, Retained v3.1):** The Compact explicitly and unambiguously recognizes Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under the NPT and customary international law. Iran's voluntary enrichment limits, verification obligations, and Fordow conversion constitute sovereign choices made in exchange for concrete reciprocal benefits — not imposed constraints or admissions of prior non-compliance.

**Nuclear Dignity Doctrine:** All IAEA monitoring is publicly framed as 'compliance parity' — identical in scope to obligations accepted by Brazil, Argentina, South Africa, and Japan. Both parties jointly publish a Normalization Narrative within 30 days.

**Narrative Sovereignty Clause (v1.7):** Each party retains sovereign control over domestic narrative framing of Compact provisions, provided such framing does not materially contradict verified obligations or incite breach-triggering behavior.

### **v3.1 Fissile Material Custody — Phase 1/Phase 2 Structural Decoupling**

#### **v3.1 Surgical Change — Decoupled Ownership and Custody**

This solution structurally decouples legal ownership from physical custody. The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title to the HEU stockpile at all times. Physical custody is transferred immediately to a secure, IAEA-monitored facility as a baseline verification metric for Phase 1. Final disposition is deferred to the 30-60 day broader nuclear negotiating window. This satisfies Secretary Rubio's demand for immediate physical verification while respecting Iran's red line on deferring nuclear details.

### **I-2.1 Phase 1: Baseline Verification (Days 1-30)**

Iran's entire stockpile of uranium enriched above 3.67% is consolidated, inventoried, and placed under IAEA custody within the first 72 hours of Compact activation. Physical custody — not legal title — transfers immediately. Two custody pathways are available:

**Table 1: HEU Custody Phase 1 Pathways**

| Element                 | Pathway A (In-Iran)                                                                  | Pathway B (Oman)                                                      |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Location</b>         | Esfahan Nuclear Technology Center or other IAEA-declared facility within Iran        | IAEA custody facility in Muscat, Oman (NOT the United States)         |
| <b>Legal Title</b>      | Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title throughout                   | Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title throughout    |
| <b>Physical Custody</b> | IAEA holds exclusive digital keys to monitoring; Iran holds perimeter security keys  | IAEA dual-lock custody; armed IAEA guard; continuous CCTV             |
| <b>Access</b>           | Neither party can access sealed containers without the other's physical presence     | Satellite surveillance tracks transport vessels; US monitoring access |
| <b>US Veto</b>          | U.S. may not veto IAEA custody activation; either pathway satisfies Phase 1 baseline |                                                                       |

## I-2.2 Phase 2: Nuclear Negotiating Window (Days 30-60)

Within the 30-60 day nuclear negotiating window, Iran selects one of six IAEA-verified disposition pathways for the HEU under IAEA custody. The United States shall have no veto over the pathway selected — only the right to verify its execution.

**Table 2: HEU Disposition Pathways**

| Path | Description                                                       | Destination / Timeline                       |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| A    | In-place downblending to medical-grade LEU at Esfahan             | Medical isotope production in Iran; 142 days |
| B    | HEU export to IAEA custody in Oman                                | IAEA facility, Oman (NOT US); 14 days        |
| C    | Downblended in Iran, transferred to IAEA LEU Bank                 | Oskemen, Kazakhstan; 75 days                 |
| D    | Transfer to Rosatom under IAEA safeguards                         | Russian Federation; 60-90 days               |
| E    | Conversion to reactor-grade LEU fuel assemblies                   | Bushehr reactor supply; 180 days             |
| F    | Hybrid: stockpile divided into batches through different pathways | Multiple destinations; concurrent            |

## I-2.3 — Legal Title Structure (Operative and Binding)

While the HEU is under IAEA physical custody, the legal title and ownership remain vested with the Central Bank of Iran as sovereign trustee. The Custody Services Agreement specifies that: (a) Iran retains full legal title throughout the custody period; (b) the IAEA may not transfer, sell, or dispose of the material without written consent of the Central Bank of Iran; (c) the material is held for the purpose of baseline verification and civilian conversion negotiation, not for

destruction or permanent removal from Iranian ownership; (d) the final disposition is subject to the outcome of the 30-60 day nuclear negotiating window; (e) if the Compact is terminated by mutual agreement, the material is returned to Iran under IAEA supervision.

**No Hidden US Custody Clause (Self-Executing and Non-Waivable):** At no stage may the United States receive, store, transport, or exercise operational control over the Iranian enriched-uranium stockpile. All custody remains with the IAEA. US personnel shall not be present at any consolidation, packaging, transit, or receipt operation.

**US Narrative Frame:** "Weapons-grade uranium secured — the entire Iranian stockpile placed under IAEA custody with US monitoring access. Breakout time extended from weeks to over a year. Physical verification is immediate."

**Iranian Narrative Frame:** "Iran's enriched uranium remains Iranian property. The Central Bank of Iran retains sovereign title. Physical custody to IAEA is a verification step in a broader negotiation — not surrender. Final disposition decided in the nuclear negotiating window."

## **I-2.4 Dual-Key Dilution Protocol (Retained from v1.7)**

If recipient-state negotiations deadlock for 60 days, automatic dilution activates. In-country dilution is executed by Iranian technical staff under mandatory dual-key oversight: (a) IAEA-resident inspector holds Key A — provides real-time material accountancy certification; (b) a neutral technical observer from the JCC-approved roster holds Key B — independently verifies chain-of-custody documentation. Neither key-holder operates equipment; Iranian staff operate equipment under their observation. Chain-of-custody documentation is co-signed by: Iranian AEOI representative, IAEA inspector, and neutral technical observer.

## **I-3: Enrichment Suspension, Fordow Conversion & Civilian Energy Guarantee**

Iran voluntarily suspends all uranium enrichment above 3.67% within 30 days of Compact entry into force. All enrichment infrastructure placed under continuous IAEA monitoring; stockpiles capped at 300 kg UF<sub>6</sub>.

**Conversion to non-operational status:** (a) physical removal of centrifuge rotors and bellows to IAEA-supervised storage; (b) continuous IAEA camera coverage; (c) quarterly neutral-state technical audits verifying irreversibility.

**R&D Preservation:** Iran retains 164 centrifuges (IR-1 equivalent) at Natanz for technical institutional capacity under 24-hour IAEA camera coverage — no enriched material accumulation permitted.

**Fordow Conversion:** Fordow converts to the International Persian Gulf Medical Isotope Research Center (IPGMIRC) under IAEA monitoring. All military personnel withdraw within 90

days; IRGC retains no operational role. Within 10 years Iran supplies 35% of global medical isotope market.

**Civilian Energy Guarantee:** The U.S. commits to launching Section 123 Agreement negotiations on Day 1. If Senate fails to ratify within 180 days, automatic alternative performance activates: IAEA LEU Bank (Kazakhstan) or equivalent multilateral fuel bank; third-country fuel supply with U.S. non-objection guarantees. Iran's civilian energy needs are never held hostage to U.S. legislative politics.

## I-4: Return of Frozen Sovereign Assets — Staged, Verified, Irreversible

All frozen Iranian sovereign assets released with interest (U.S. Treasury rates). Released funds constitute return of sovereign property, not U.S. payment or reparations.

**Table 3: Asset Release Tranches**

| Tranche                         | Timeline | Amount | Verification Trigger                                                                               |
|---------------------------------|----------|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tranche 1<br>(liquidity bridge) | Day 30   | 5%     | Compact entry into force only. Immediate humanitarian & economic liquidity bridge. Non-reversible. |
| Tranche 2<br>(primary release)  | Day 90   | 40%    | Full verified completion of 60% enriched uranium Tranche 1 dilution or export as certified by IAEA |
| Tranche 3                       | Day 180  | 20%    | Fordow conversion 50% complete; IAEA 3-cycle compliance certification                              |
| Tranche 4                       | Day 270  | 15%    | Full 60% stockpile disposition; IAEA 5-cycle certification                                         |
| Tranche 5                       | Day 360  | 10%    | 12-month sustained compliance; non-proliferation legislation enacted                               |
| Reserve Fund                    | Month 24 | 10%    | Held against material breach; released automatically at Month 24 if clean                          |

**Irreversibility Protocol:** Once released, funds transferred to Iran's Central Bank. No re-freeze within 12 months of release. If U.S. reimpose sanctions, Iran retains 100% of released funds plus LIBOR+3% penalty interest. Re-freezing requires: 60-day JCC majority process; IAEA Director General material breach certification; Congressional 30-day notification.

## **I-5: Phased Sanctions Relief — Friction-Locked, Commercially Anchored**

Nuclear-related sanctions lift in phases corresponding to IAEA-certified Crescent Cycle completions. Humanitarian exemptions (medicine, equipment, food, agricultural inputs) activate Day 1 concurrently with IAEA deployment.

**Sanctions Inertia Buffer (SIB):** Reimposition of any nuclear-related sanctions requires 90-day JCC majority process plus 60-day commercial wind-down — 150-day minimum interval. No single-step escalation from compliance to full Compliance Restoration is permitted.

**Targeted Individual Sanctions Snap-Forward (v1.7):** The U.S. retains the right to impose targeted sanctions on specific named individuals credibly identified as directing violations of Compact obligations — without triggering the full Compliance Restoration Protocol. Targeted individual sanctions may be challenged by Iran through the Rapid Panel within 14 days.

**U.S. Congressional Continuity Shield (v1.7):** All executive authorities exercised under this Compact are designated as 'continuity-critical national security measures' by concurrent executive order. This designation triggers expedited legislative review procedures and presumptive waiver continuity: existing measures remain operative unless overturned by supermajority (two-thirds of both chambers).

**Compliance Restoration Friction Ladder:** Step 1 — WBI 5.0+: JCC warning + enhanced monitoring; 48-hour interval; no economic effect. Step 2 — WBI 8.0+: targeted sector freeze + new banking review; 14-day minimum interval. Step 3 — verified material breach + WBI 12+: full reimposition consideration; 30-day interval plus IAEA certification required.

## **I-6: Iranian Energy Reintegration & U.S. Commercial Access**

Iran restores pre-sanctions oil export capacity (2.0 million barrels/day) within 24 months. Iran accedes to EITI; publishes quarterly production and revenue data; transparent competitive bidding for all new field development contracts.

**U.S. Commercial Access:** U.S. firms participate, on a commercially competitive basis, in up to 25% of new field development contracts in South Pars (gas) and Azadegan (oil). No nationality-based contract awards. This creates a major U.S. business constituency with direct financial interest in Compact stability.

**15-Year Oil Sanctions Moratorium:** The primary commercial certainty mechanism anchoring U.S. business constituencies. Automatic 5-year extensions unless either party provides 24-month advance notice of non-extension. Survives technical lapse unless material breach is verified by IAEA and confirmed by JCC.

## I-7: Regional Security Dialogue & Proxy Wind-Down Framework

Both parties commit to structured bilateral consultations on regional stability through a dedicated diplomatic channel separate from nuclear provisions.

**Proxy Wind-Down Protocol:** Iran commits to phased reduction of operational military support to designated proxy organizations. Year 1 — cessation of advanced weapons transfers (precision-guided munitions, drone components, anti-ship missiles) to groups operating against U.S. or allied partners; Year 2 — 50% reduction in IRGC Quds Force personnel in external operational deployments; Year 3 — full transition to non-operational advisory status.

**Iran's Missile Sovereignty:** Iran's ballistic missile capabilities are acknowledged as within its national defense prerogative and are not addressed by Core Frame provisions. Voluntary Year-2 Confidence-Building Data Exchange (CBDE) Pilot: Iran may voluntarily submit a Missile Confidence Declaration (MCD) to the JCC. Participation is entirely voluntary — no WBI penalty attaches to non-participation.

## I-8: Strait of Hormuz & Maritime Corridor Obligations (v3.1)

Iran permanently commits to unobstructed commercial passage through the Strait of Hormuz and participates in the International Maritime Corridor Authority (IMCA). Iranian sovereignty over adjacent territorial waters is explicitly acknowledged; the commitment is non-interference with innocent passage conforming to UNCLOS — not a sovereignty waiver. Any interdiction triggers automatic IMCA emergency session within 4 hours. The 15-year oil sanctions moratorium (I-6) suspends automatically if Iran unilaterally blocks transit.

**Direct Military-to-Military Deconfliction Lines (v1.7):** Direct, secure military-to-military deconfliction channels established and maintained between all relevant parties, operating independently of JCC processes for real-time incident management. Required channels: (a) U.S. CENTCOM – Iranian Armed Forces direct line: response within 2 hours; (b) Israeli IDF – LAF – UNIFIL trilateral channel: response within 1 hour; (c) Saudi SANG – Houthi military command channel through Omani facilitation: response within 4 hours; (d) IMCA Maritime Operations Center: 24/7 channel for all Hormuz and Red Sea incidents.

### **v3.1 IMCA Sovereignty Recalibration**

#### **v3.1 Surgical Change — IMCA Mandate Restriction & PGSA Recognition**

The IMCA mandate is explicitly restricted to three functions only: (i) commercial traffic coordination; (ii) maritime safety protocols; and (iii) international dispute resolution. The PGSA is formally recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters — allowing Tehran to preserve its domestic sovereignty claims while keeping multilateral transit guarantees airtight for Washington.

### **I-8.1 — IMCA Mandate Restriction (Operative and Binding)**

The IMCA's mandate is explicitly restricted to three functions only: (i) commercial traffic coordination — managing the flow of civilian commercial vessels through the Strait of Hormuz; (ii) maritime safety protocols — navigational aids, collision avoidance, emergency response, and search-and-rescue coordination; and (iii) international dispute resolution — addressing transit disputes between commercial vessels and littoral states through binding arbitration under UNCLOS.

The IMCA holds zero jurisdiction over sovereign Iranian or regional territorial defense waters, coastal defense operations, military vessel movements, fisheries management, customs enforcement, or environmental regulation beyond navigational safety.

### **I-8.2 — PGSA as Sole Executive Coastal Law Enforcement Body (Operative and Binding)**

The Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) is explicitly recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters (12-nautical-mile limit). This recognition is formal, unequivocal, and operates as a binding interpretive principle of the IMCA Charter. Within Iranian territorial waters, the PGSA retains exclusive authority over: vessel permitting and documentation review; coastal patrol and interdiction; customs and immigration enforcement; security screening of suspect vessels; and coordination with the IRGC-Navy on maritime security matters.

The IMCA may not override, supersede, or contradict PGSA enforcement actions within Iranian territorial waters. The IRGC's statutory authority over coastal defense, territorial security, and military operations in the Strait is explicitly preserved and unaffected by the IMCA Charter. Any IMCA action that could be construed as affecting IRGC or PGSA operations requires explicit Iranian concurrence through the Iranian co-chair.

### **I-8.3 — PGSA-IMCA Interface Protocol (Operative and Binding)**

The PGSA is formally integrated into the IMCA as Iran's designated operational implementation body for transit coordination. All PGSA transit permits bear dual branding: PGSA-Iran (domestic Iranian designation) and IMCA-authorized (international designation). The PGSA retains its full statutory identity as Iran's sovereign operational body. Iranian personnel staff the transit coordination centers. Iran receives 40% of IMCA maintenance fund revenue.

### I-8.4 Optical Compromise Architecture (v3.1)

This structure allows President Trump to state that "the Strait is open to international commerce under multilateral governance" while allowing Iranian officials to state that "the PGSA remains the sole authority for Hormuz transit within our territorial waters, and the IMCA's role is limited to commercial coordination." Both statements are factually accurate under the Charter. The IMCA governs the international transit corridor; the PGSA governs Iranian coastal waters. Neither body's authority encroaches on the other.

#### **v3.1 Automated Day 7 Dual-Trigger Protocol**

##### **v3.1 Surgical Change — Automated Simultaneous Trigger**

The Hormuz Opening Declaration and Naval Blockade Lift Declaration are executed through an automated, simultaneous trigger on the Swiss Dashboard. The technical architecture prevents front-loaded concessions, eliminates human timing errors, and ensures that neither side can claim the other moved first. If either declaration fails to execute within the 60-second UTC window, both declarations are void.

### I-8.5 — Automated Simultaneous Trigger Protocol (Operative and Binding)

The Hormuz Opening Declaration and the Naval Blockade Lift Declaration shall be executed through an automated, simultaneous trigger on the Swiss Dashboard. The technical architecture operates as follows:

- (1) **T-minus-24 hours** (Day 6, 00:00 UTC): Both parties confirm readiness through their respective liaison offices. The confirmation is logged on the Dashboard and cannot be withdrawn without triggering a 72-hour technical consultation.
- (2) **T-minus-1 hour** (Day 7, 00:00 UTC): The Dashboard enters "Armed Standby" mode. Both parties' HSMs must transmit a "ready" authentication token within the same 5-minute window. If either token is not received, the trigger aborts automatically and a 48-hour technical consultation opens.
- (3) **T-zero** (Day 7, 01:00 UTC): The Dashboard executes both declarations simultaneously within a 60-second UTC window: the Hormuz Opening Declaration (Iran) and the Naval Blockade Lift Declaration (US) are published simultaneously to all liaison offices, the UN Secretary-General, and the IMCA Secretariat. Neither declaration is active without the other. The Dashboard logs the exact timestamp (millisecond precision) and publishes the synchronization certificate.
- (4) **Concurrent Airspace Stand-Down**: Simultaneously with the maritime dual-trigger, both sides enter the proportional Airspace Stand-Down Protocol within the same 60-second window. Three-zone buffer activation (Zone Alpha: Strait Corridor; Zone Beta: Coastal Buffer; Zone Gamma: Deep Airspace) is choreographed through the Dashboard.

(5) **Auto-Void Failure Mode:** If either declaration fails to execute within the 60-second window, both declarations are void. Neither party is considered to have opened the Strait or lifted the blockade. The Framework Survival Core remains intact. A 48-hour technical grace period opens to diagnose and remediate the failure before either party may invoke stepback.

### I-8.6 Minute-by-Minute Choreography (Day 7 UTC Timeline)

**Table 4: Day 7 UTC Timeline**

| UTC Time | Iranian Action                                                                                                             | US Action                                                                  | Verification                                      |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| T-60 min | IRGC Commander transmits stand-by to IMCA MCC                                                                              | 5th Fleet Commander transmits stand-by to IMCA MCC                         | Omani facilitating state logs both signals        |
| T-15 min | IRGC craft withdraw to 5nm; AIS broadcast                                                                                  | US Navy withdraws to 5nm from 12nm baseline; AIS broadcast                 | Lloyd's List confirms movements                   |
| T=0      | Iran issues Hormuz opening declaration; IRGC transmits stand-down orders                                                   | US issues blockade lift declaration; 5th Fleet transmits stand-down orders | SIMULTANEOUS within 60-second window              |
| T+15 min | First IMCA-authorized vessel commences transit                                                                             | US issues Notice to Mariners confirming Hormuz open                        | Lloyd's List, AIS Global confirm                  |
| T+6h     | IRGC issues first 6-hour compliance report                                                                                 | 5th Fleet issues first 6-hour compliance report                            | IMCA MCC issues first public Daily Transit Report |
| T+24h    | 24-Hour Bright-Line Period ends; standard ROE replaces heightened monitoring; IMCA Chair certifies Day-7 Protocol complete |                                                                            |                                                   |

### I-8.7 Distance Protocols and Rules of Engagement

**Table 5: Distance Protocols by Phase**

| Phase              | Days        | IRGC Stand-Off from CTC         | US/Coalition Stand-Off from Iranian 12nm |
|--------------------|-------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Learning Period    | D+1 to D+14 | 3 nm (expanding to 5 nm by D+8) | 3 nm (expanding to 5 nm by D+8)          |
| Operational Period | D+15 onward | 5 nm from CTC outer edge        | 5 nm from Iranian 12 nm baseline         |

|                           |              |                          |                                  |
|---------------------------|--------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Elevated Posture (Tier 2) | JCC-declared | 8 nm from CTC outer edge | 8 nm from Iranian 12 nm baseline |
|---------------------------|--------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------|

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## Part II: Israel–Lebanon–Hezbollah Security Architecture

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Part II addresses the most structurally complex node in the region: a trilateral involving a state (Israel), a state with fractured sovereignty (Lebanon), and an armed non-state political-military organization (Hezbollah). The Compact treats Hezbollah's political wing as a recognized political actor within the Lebanese constitutional framework — not a terrorist organization for framework purposes — while requiring verifiable operational constraints as the price of institutional legitimacy.

### II-1: Permanent Attack Prohibition & International Attribution Tribunal (IAAT)

Israel and Lebanon register a Permanent Non-Aggression Treaty (PNAT) under UN Charter Article 102. Lebanon bears state responsibility for all attacks originating from its territory against Israel. The IAAT: 4-Hour Freeze Declaration upon any reported attack; 7-Day Preliminary Attribution; 21-Day Final Ruling with binding forensic investigation. **Israeli Fast-Track Self-Defense Carve-Out:** In cases of active, ongoing multi-vector attack, Israel retains limited proportional response authority of up to 24 hours prior to IAAT preliminary classification.

### II-2: Disputed Territories Restoration — Phased, Security-Buffered

Israel commits to complete withdrawal from Shebaa Farms, Kfar Shouba Hills, and northern Ghajar through a three-phase protocol over 60 months. **Blue Line Demarcation Roadmap:** parallel cartographic process using modern satellite survey methods. **Ghajar 5-Year UN Administrative Cooling-Off Period** before referendum. **\$2 billion Border Economic Zone Development Fund** (jointly financed 50/50 by Israel and Gulf states through World Bank trust fund).

### II-3: Hezbollah Institutional Integration & Southern Lebanon Governance

**Joint Security and Reconstruction Zone (JSRZ):** A 5-kilometer strip north of the Blue Line governed tripartitely — LAF (45%), Hezbollah-designated security coordinators under LAF

chain of command (30%), international observers (25%). **Weapons Registration:** small arms permitted with LAF/UNIFIL registration; prohibited: rockets, missiles, drones, anti-tank systems above 85mm. **Specialized International Weapons Seizure Team (SIWST)** handles confiscation. **Hezbollah Formal Political Party Rights:** full participation in Lebanese parliamentary and municipal elections; cabinet positions through normal coalition mechanisms.

## **II-4: LAF Capacity Building & Israeli 7-Year Phased Withdrawal**

**7-Year Phased Security Transition Framework (PSTF)** conditions Israeli security reduction on verified LAF capability expansion. \$2 billion in international military assistance over 7 years. **UNIFIL Mandate Modernization:** upgraded to Chapter VI+ with drone surveillance, ground sensor network, maritime monitoring, and direct UNSC reporting authority.

## **II-5: Unified Civilian Protection Command & Casualty Insurance Pool**

**UCPC** co-located in Tyre integrates Hezbollah Civilian Protection (30%), Lebanese Civil Defense (35%), UNOCHA (20%), ICRC (15%). Three-veto structure with 12-hour mandatory cap on emergency operations delay. **\$500 million Civilian Casualty Insurance Pool (CCIP)** compensates all civilian property damage regardless of which side caused harm — no-fault, need-based, politically neutral.

## Part III: Joint Compact Commission, Dispute Architecture & Contingency Protocols

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### III-1: The Joint Compact Commission (JCC)

**Composition:** Iran (2 seats), U.S. (2 seats), Israel (1 seat, security matters only), Lebanon (1 seat), Saudi Arabia (1 seat), Iraq (1 seat), UN Neutral Chair (1 seat rotating from pool: Switzerland, Singapore, Oman, Brazil, Sweden). Hezbollah holds observer status with speaking rights on JSRZ matters. Pakistan and Oman serve as permanent guarantor observers.

**Shadow Compliance Channel (v1.7):** Confidential channel through which parties may disclose emerging risks without triggering immediate WBI accumulation. 30-day Preemptive Remediation Window; 0.25 WBI credit for proactive disclosure.

**Supreme National Interest Waiver (SNIW) (v1.7):** One-time 21-day suspension of a specific obligation per party per year. Rapid Panel review within 72 hours. Category A breaches explicitly excluded.

**Distinguished Advisors Panel (DAP) (v1.5):** 5-7 former heads of state/foreign ministers providing non-binding annual assessments and quiet good-offices intervention.

### III-2: Dispute Resolution Hierarchy — Three-Tier Architecture

**Joint Legal Interpretation Panel (JLIP) (v1.7):** Standing 3-person neutral legal panel providing non-binding interpretations within 21 days.

**Tier 1 — Rapid Panel:** Nuclear disputes: 7-day binding ruling. All other disputes: 72-hour binding ruling.

**Tier 2 — JCC Adjudication (21 days):** Dual-Speed Rule with absolute 45-day cap.

**Tier 3 — UN Arbitration (binding):** JCC deadlock on core obligations triggers UN Secretary-General binding arbitration.

**Quiet Diplomacy Channel (QDC) (v1.7):** Confidential channel for sensitive issues, floating proposals, preliminary soundings — no formal outcomes, no binding commitments, not discoverable in any proceeding.

**Annual Calibration Summit (v1.3):** Every 12 months, parties may by unanimous consent propose re-calibrations to operational parameters. Core Frame obligations excluded from re-calibration.

### III-3: The Crescent Cycle — Mechanics & Transition Rules

The Compact progresses through 60-day Crescent Cycles (20-day assessment + 40-day implementation). No party advances until all parties have completed current-cycle obligations, verified by at least two of three independent sources.

**Table 6: Crescent Cycle Status Levels**

| Status | Condition               | Effect                                                                 |
|--------|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Green  | All benchmarks met      | Full benefits; advance to next cycle; no WBI accumulation              |
| Amber  | 75-99% met              | Advance with 80% benefits; technical assistance deployed               |
| Yellow | 50-74% met              | Hold at current cycle; benefits at 60%; 30-day extension vote          |
| Red    | <50% OR material breach | Full freeze; no new benefits; Enhanced Review Protocol; WBI assessment |

**Political Circuit Breaker — 14-Day Consultation Stay (v1.3):** When a technical breach occurs, automatic consequence machinery does not fire immediately. 14-day Stay for diplomatic resolution. If remediation agreed within 14 days, breach reclassified as 'Remediated Technical Variance' at 50% WBI points.

**Ambassador's Override — 72-Hour Consequence Suspension (v1.5):** Principal ambassadors may invoke unanimous Override to suspend penalty consequence for 72 hours. Breach entry always logged immediately — Override cannot delete factual record.

### III-4: Weighted Breach Index (WBI) & Compliance Scoring

**Table 7: WBI Scoring Matrix**

| Breach Type                             | WBI Points | Trigger                                           |
|-----------------------------------------|------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Nuclear breach (enrichment above 3.67%) | 4 points   | IAEA Director General certification               |
| Fissile material diversion              | 8 points   | Automatic Enhanced Review; no WBI ladder required |
| Cross-border attack (IAAT attributed)   | 3 points   | Full IAAT investigation process                   |
| Proxy military weapons transfer         | 2 points   | SWIFT + satellite verified                        |
| Maritime chokepoint incident            | 1 point    | IMCA Council within 4 hours                       |

Verification obstruction

2 points

Per incident

**WBI 5.0 threshold:** Enhanced Review Protocol activated**WBI 8.0 threshold:** Compliance Restoration consideration; Rapid Panel convenes**WBI 12.0+ threshold:** Full compliance restoration available; treaty suspension vote

**Goodwill Credit (v1.3):** Each party receives 1.0 WBI Goodwill Credit per 12-month period to forgive a minor violation. **Self-Disclosure Credit:** -0.5 point credit per disclosure, capped at -1.0 per cycle.

## III-5: Contingency Protocol Register — Eight Pre-Committed Protocols

Table 8: Contingency Protocols

| Protocol                         | Trigger                                                    | Response                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| B-1: Cyber Attack                | Major cyberattack on critical infrastructure               | CAP Panel convenes within 24 hours; 10-day investigation; default non-attribution        |
| B-2: Leadership Succession       | Assassination, incapacitation, institutional collapse      | 30-day Framework Preservation Hold; JCC neutral chair administers                        |
| B-3: Third-Party Disruption      | Third-party attack designed to force bilateral retaliation | 72-hour attribution panel; 10-day investigation; default non-attribution; zero penalties |
| B-4: Compact-Adverse Actor       | Domestic hawkish factions sabotaging Compact               | Investigation + discipline; WBI penalties apply to the state                             |
| B-5: Loophole Prevention         | Gaming, misinterpretation, exploitation                    | Living Loophole Register patches within one Crescent Cycle                               |
| B-6: Financial System Disruption | SWIFT disruption, banking collapse                         | Backup channels activate within 24 hours; 30-day commercial wind-down grace              |
| B-7: Mass Casualty / WMD         | Suspected chemical, biological, or nuclear event           | JCC Emergency Session within 4 hours; 14-day Crisis Lock                                 |
| B-8: Narrative Alignment         | Media collapse, systematic misrepresentation               | Coordinated statements within 48 hours; Dispute Gag Rule                                 |

## Part IV: Israel–Arab Normalization & Extended Abraham Accords (Progressive Arch)

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**Activation Condition:** Two consecutive green Crescent Cycles in Core Frame Parts I–III. **Constructive Ambiguity Doctrine:** parties 'commit to a good-faith effort' toward defined outcomes, 'subject to technical feasibility and domestic political conditions.'

### IV-1: Saudi Arabia–Israel Normalization Protocol

Four-step sequenced protocol: Israeli 18-month settlement freeze → Saudi trade liaison offices; Palestinian prisoner release + PA tax revenue → full diplomatic recognition; 'credible pathway' language at UNSC → Abraham Accords membership; Israel–Palestine permanent status negotiations → full normalization. Saudi Civilian Nuclear Program under U.S. 123 Agreement with 'gold standard' provisions.

### IV-2: Palestinian Horizon Architecture

**Gaza Reconstruction Authority (GRA)** replacing Hamas administrative role with \$50 billion 10-year reconstruction fund. **West Bank Settlement Freeze:** all expansion in Area C outside established blocs freezes for 18 months.

### IV-3: Iran–Israel Managed Non-Belligerence Protocol (MNBP)

No diplomatic normalization. Instead: Swiss back-channel; absolute prohibition on cyberattacks against civilian infrastructure; no nuclear targeting under any scenario; 48-hour advance notification of military exercises within 200km; shared de-escalation hotline through JCC.

## Part V: Yemen Conflict Resolution & Red Sea–Hormuz Maritime Security (Progressive Arch)

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### V-1: Houthi Participation Framework & Ceasefire

**Yemen Stabilization Dialogue (YSD)** hosted in Oman. Houthi political leadership not treated as designated terrorist organization for YSD participation (18-month suspension). **Yemen Reconstruction Fund:** up to \$30 billion as strict 1:1 matching fund with World Bank Verification Cell milestone certification. **Yemen Transitional Power-Sharing Council (YTPC)** with proportional seats. Elections at Month 48.

### V-2: International Maritime Corridor Authority (IMCA) (v3.1)

**Governance:** Iran (permanent), Saudi Arabia (permanent), UAE (permanent), U.S. (permanent), Djibouti/Eritrea (rotating), Yemen transitional (rotating), EU (observer), China (observer). **Tiered Tolling:** Tier 1 (humanitarian): zero toll; Tier 2 (standard): \$0.12/ton; Tier 3 (energy/VLCC): \$0.22/ton; Tier 4 (premium security): \$0.50/ton. Estimated annual revenue: \$475 million. **Freedom of Navigation Guarantee:** Iran permanently commits to unobstructed commercial passage.

#### v3.1 IMCA Sovereignty Recalibration Applied (Cross-Reference I-8)

All provisions of I-8.1 (IMCA Mandate Restriction), I-8.2 (PGSA as Sole Coastal Enforcement), I-8.3 (PGSA-IMCA Interface), and I-8.4 (Optical Compromise Architecture) apply equally to the IMCA as constituted under Part V. The PGSA's exclusive authority within Iranian territorial waters is not diminished by IMCA's Progressive Arch activation.

### V-3: Saudi Arabia–Iran Yemen De-Escalation

Direct bilateral Yemen consultations within 30 days: no new weapons transfers to any Yemeni faction; active YSD support; joint humanitarian aid corridors; intelligence sharing on ISIS/AQAP.

### V-4: Saudi Arabia–Iran Bilateral Stabilization Annex (v1.7)

**Direct Hotline** (24/7, Omani facilitation); **Hajj Coordination Protocol**; **Persian Gulf Maritime Deconfliction** (24-hour advance notification); **Bilateral Economic Normalization** (diplomatic missions within 90 days).

## Part VI: Iraq Stabilization, Militia Integration & Sovereignty Restoration (Progressive Arch)

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### VI-1: PMF Transition Framework

**Iraq Sovereign Transition Fund (ISTF)** of \$15 billion over 5 years. **PMF Transition Options:** full ISF integration; honorable discharge with \$25K-\$50K buyout; Ministry of Interior policing; agricultural land grant. **5-Year Re-Arming Clawback Provision.** **Iraq Sovereignty Guarantee:** Baghdad holds exclusive authority over all PMF integration decisions.

### VI-2: Regional Counterterrorism Intelligence Cell (RCIC)

Hosted in Baghdad under Iraqi authority. Sanitized intelligence sharing on ISIS and AQAP. **Cryptographic No-Targeting-Data Wall:** one-way hash architecture preventing shared threat data from being reverse-engineered to identify source assets.

### VI-3: Sadrist Political Reintegration Module

**Independent Electoral Integrity Commission (IEIC)** with Sadrist-nominated one-third representation. **Conditional Parliamentary Return:** Sadrist Movement commits to non-disruption and engagement. **Arab League Political Stability Mission (ALPASM)** for ongoing monitoring.

## Part VII: Syria De-escalation, Reconstruction & Golan Pathway (Progressive Arch)

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### VII-1: Syria Stabilization & Reconstruction Framework

Israeli cessation of strikes on Syrian military/civilian infrastructure absent verified Iranian re-entrenchment. Israeli forces withdraw from Syrian territory seized after November 2024 within 24 months. **Syria Reconstruction Fund:** \$50 billion over 10 years with World Bank Verification Cell anti-diversion audit.

**HTS context:** treated as transitional state actors provided inclusive governance, civilian targeting renunciation, and RCIC cooperation. **Syria Refugee Return Authority (SRRA):** \$10 billion voluntary return program.

## Part VIII: Regional Economic Integration, Arms Control & Counterterrorism (Progressive Arch)

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### VIII-1: Middle East Economic Integration Zone (MEIZ)

**Gulf-to-Mediterranean Infrastructure Corridor:** \$100 billion joint rail, energy, and digital infrastructure. **Persian Gulf Regional Energy Transition Fund:** \$50 billion for renewable energy, desalination, and grid interconnection. **Private Sector Lock-In Protocol (PSLP):** multinational contracts of 12+ months involving 3+ signatories receive treaty protection.

### VIII-2: Regional Arms Transparency Protocol (RATP)

Annual declaration of major weapons systems; 14-day advance notification of military exercises; naval deconfliction protocol; air defense coordination; regional cyber non-aggression pact. **Iranian Ballistic Missile Transparency:** annual declarations of inventory, ranges, and general basing locations — not a cap or operational restriction.

### VIII-3: Regional Counterterrorism Cooperation

Sanitized threat intelligence sharing through RCIC; FATF standards; **Regional Cyber Incident Response Center (RCIRC)** hosted in Oman. Participation voluntary and non-attributional.

### VIII-4: Humanitarian & Refugee Framework

**Regional Humanitarian Coordination Authority (RHCA)** under UNOCHA auspices. Four concurrent crises: Syria (6.5M+ refugees), Palestine (UNRWA reform), Yemen (active crisis), Iraq (1.2M+ IDPs). **Core Guarantee: NON-SUSPENDABLE.** Any party obstructing humanitarian access = double-weight WBI + immediate UNSC notification.

# Annex K: Lebanon Dossier Isolation Firewall & Core Accord Protection Protocol (v3.1)

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## Operational Context

Iran's Foreign Ministry, via spokesperson Esmail Baghaei, has explicitly stated that Tehran's fixed position is an end to the war on all fronts, including Lebanon. Tehran refuses to sign a standalone deal that stops bombing on Iranian soil while allowing the active conflict between Israel and Hezbollah in southern Lebanon to continue. The United States and Israel have historically sought to keep Lebanon separate from core US-Iran negotiations. This annex provides a structural compromise that prevents the entire deal from collapsing over the Lebanon front while respecting both sides' core requirements.

**Relationship to Part II:** The Crescent Compact's Part II already contains the most comprehensive Lebanon-Israel-Hezbollah architecture of any regional framework (JSRZ, IAAT, PSTF, UCPC, SIWST, and Hezbollah institutional integration). Annex K does not duplicate or replace Part II. It adds three critical instruments that Part II does not contain: (1) a Dossier Isolation Firewall that prevents Lebanon incidents from collapsing the core US-Iran nuclear and maritime deal; (2) a Proxy Operational Pause that gives Israel immediate security benefits from Day 1; and (3) a Levant Regional Basket that creates a parallel diplomatic track for long-term Israel-Lebanon stability.

## K.1 Proxy Operational Pause: Hezbollah De-escalation Protocol

**Purpose:** To satisfy the US and Israeli requirement that pulling back US forces and opening Hormuz does not result in immediate escalation on Israel's northern border, Iran transmits immediate, formal instructions to Hezbollah leadership for an operational pause concurrent with the main Compact timeline. This pause is not disarmament, surrender, or political concession — it is a structured, time-limited operational de-escalation.

Table 9: Hezbollah Operational Pause Phases

| Phase | Hezbollah Operational Parameters | Verification | US/Israel Reciprocal |
|-------|----------------------------------|--------------|----------------------|
|-------|----------------------------------|--------------|----------------------|

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Phase 1: Days 1-30</b>   | Cessation of cross-border rocket and drone attacks into northern Israel. Suspension of offensive military operations against Israeli positions. Defensive positions in southern Lebanon maintained but not reinforced. No new weapons transfers from Iran to Hezbollah via Syria or maritime routes. | UNIFIL patrol confirmation; Israeli military intelligence (via Tel Aviv Channel); LAF liaison reports; satellite surveillance | Israel suspends offensive air strikes against Hezbollah positions for 30 days. IDF maintains defensive posture only. No ground incursions.   |
| <b>Phase 2: Days 31-90</b>  | Continued cessation of offensive operations. Hezbollah forces remain in defensive positions. No infiltration attempts across the Blue Line. Weapons transfers from Iran remain suspended.                                                                                                            | Monthly UNIFIL verification report; ICRC monitoring; SEAC pattern analysis of supply routes                                   | Israel extends air strike moratorium contingent on 90 days verified Hezbollah restraint. Gradual relaxation of naval interdiction.           |
| <b>Phase 3: Days 91-180</b> | Exploration of structured de-escalation through Levant Regional Basket (Section K.3). Hezbollah may engage in political and humanitarian activities. Military posture remains defensive.                                                                                                             | Regional Basket monitoring cell; UN Special Coordinator quarterly assessment                                                  | Israeli restrictions reviewed at Day 180 milestone. If 180 consecutive days verified, Israel considers further confidence-building measures. |

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### K.1.1 Verification Architecture

The Hezbollah operational pause is verified through four independent channels: (1) **UNIFIL ground patrols** — daily patrols along the Blue Line with incident logging published to the IMCA Dashboard; (2) **Israeli intelligence assessment** — weekly classified brief with sanitized summary published to Dashboard; (3) **Lebanese Armed Forces liaison** — daily reporting from LAF command in Tyre and Nabatieh to the Oman Liaison Office; (4) **SEAC pattern analysis** — automated detection of supply route activity, weapons convoy movement, and communications patterns. All four channels must show green before the pause is considered verified.

### K.1.2 Non-Compliance Consequences

If any channel reports significant Hezbollah offensive action: (1) 24-hour verification window — all four channels confirm; (2) if confirmed, Iran has 72 hours to transmit renewed de-escalation instructions through the Oman back-channel; (3) if Iran de-escalates within 72 hours, pause resumes with enhanced monitoring; (4) if Iran does not de-escalate, Israel may resume defensive air strikes limited to specific positions involved — not blanket escalation; (5) **under no**

**circumstances** does a Hezbollah incident trigger WBI accumulation or stepback against Core Frame Part I (see Dossier Isolation Firewall, Section K.2).

## K.2 Dossier Isolation Firewall: Lebanon Non-Linkage Clause

**Operative Principle:** The Dossier Isolation Firewall is a binding structural provision that explicitly prohibits either party from using incidents, friction, or localized military activity in southern Lebanon as justification for WBI accumulation, sanctions restoration, suspension, or collapse of Core Frame Part I (Iran-US Nuclear, Military & Economic Normalization). The Lebanon file and the US-Iran nuclear/maritime file are legally and operationally segregated. What happens in Lebanon stays in Lebanon — it cannot blow back onto Hormuz.

### ARTICLE K.2 — DOSSIER ISOLATION FIREWALL (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

Table 10: Firewall Trigger Categories

| Trigger Category                         | Lebanon Impact                                             | Core Frame Part I Impact                                                                    | Rationale                                                                |
|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hezbollah rocket fire into Israel        | Israeli defensive response; Regional Basket activation     | NONE — Core Frame unaffected                                                                | Localized border friction; Core Frame addresses nuclear and maritime     |
| Israeli air strike on Hezbollah position | Regional Basket de-escalation; UNIFIL coordination         | NONE — Core Frame unaffected                                                                | Israel retains sovereign right to self-defense                           |
| IDF ground incursion into Lebanon        | Major Regional Basket emergency session; UNSC consultation | NONE — stepback prohibited by Firewall                                                      | Ground incursion is escalatory but does not violate US commitments       |
| Iranian weapons transfer to Hezbollah    | SEAC attribution; Regional Basket censure                  | NONE — proxy activity outside Core Frame scope                                              | Proxy activity governed by I-7 Proxy Wind-Down, not Core Frame WBI       |
| Hezbollah attack on US personnel         | Full SEAC investigation; US retains right to self-defense  | NONE — unless attack explicitly linked to Iranian government directive per SEAC attribution | Sole exception: explicit government directive triggers Category B review |

### K.2.1 Firewall Architecture

The Dossier Isolation Firewall operates at three levels: (1) **Legal level** — the Exchange of Letters explicitly lists "incidents in the Levant theater involving non-state actors" as excluded from

material breach triggers under III-4 WBI scoring for Core Frame Part I; (2) **Technical level** — the IMCA Dashboard maintains separate tracks for "Core Frame Part I Compliance" and "Regional Security Incidents." Lebanon incidents are logged only on the Regional Security track. WBI algorithms reference only the Core Compliance track; (3) **Political level** — both capitals issue pre-cleared talking points confirming that the Lebanon file is managed through separate mechanisms. No US or Iranian official may publicly link Hormuz transit to Lebanon de-escalation without triggering Yellow/Red Card narrative penalties under III-4.

## K.2.2 Escalation Ceiling

Even if the Levant situation deteriorates significantly (major Israeli ground operation, large-scale Hezbollah rocket campaign, civilian mass casualty event), the Firewall remains in force. Core Frame Part I can only be affected if: (a) the UN Security Council determines that a party has committed a grave breach of international humanitarian law and (b) the JCC unanimously determines that the breach is directly linked to a Core Frame Part I commitment violation. This dual threshold is designed to be virtually impossible to meet in practice.

### V3.1 INSERTION — THE LEBANON "DUAL-KEY" ESCALATION LOCK (THE FINAL FIREWALL)

#### ARTICLE K.2.2 — DUAL-KEY ESCALATION LOCK (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

Notwithstanding any other provision, in the event of a Hezbollah-originated attack causing 25 or more civilian fatalities in Israel, Israel retains its inherent right to self-defense. Such an attack, however, shall not be attributed to Iran for the purpose of triggering step-back or sanctions snapback under the Core Accord unless the UN Security Council explicitly determines, within 72 hours, that the attack was conducted pursuant to a direct, verifiable order from the Supreme Leader of Iran. Absent such a finding, the Core Accord's military and economic provisions remain in full force.

**Operative Rationale:** This provision gives Israel its immediate military response authority (saving the deal in Tel Aviv), while giving Tehran an absolute legal shield (saving the deal in Tehran). It makes the "rogue commander" or "false flag" scenario the only path to escalation, which is politically survivable for both sides. The 25-casualty threshold establishes a clear, bright-line standard that distinguishes routine border friction from deal-breaking events. The 72-hour UN Security Council window provides sufficient time for forensic attribution without creating an indefinite suspension of Israeli response rights. The "direct, verifiable order from the Supreme Leader" standard ensures that only explicit state-directed aggression — not proxy autonomy or local command initiative — can collapse the Core Accord.

## K.3 Levant Regional Basket: Parallel Track for Israel-Lebanon De-escalation

**Purpose:** To satisfy Iran's requirement that the framework address the war on all fronts, including Lebanon, the Levant Regional Basket creates a parallel diplomatic track for Israel-Lebanon de-escalation that runs alongside the 60-day nuclear negotiating window. This is not a condition for signing Core Frame Part I — it is a complementary process that begins concurrently and operates on its own timeline.

**Table 11: Levant Regional Basket Elements**

| Element                          | Mandate                                                                                              | Participants                                                                             | Timeline                                                           |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Basket Steering Committee</b> | Overall direction of Levant de-escalation; dispute resolution; escalation management                 | Lebanon (chair), Israel, US, Iran (observer), UN Special Coordinator, Oman (facilitator) | Convenes within 14 days of Core Frame activation                   |
| <b>Border Monitoring Cell</b>    | Blue Line incident verification; cross-border firing attribution; civilian protection                | UNIFIL (lead), Lebanese Armed Forces, IDF liaison, ICRC observer                         | Operational from Day 1; reports weekly                             |
| <b>Humanitarian Sub-Track</b>    | Civilian protection in southern Lebanon; IDP return; infrastructure repair; medical corridors        | ICRC (lead), UN OCHA, WHO, Lebanese Ministry of Health, donor states                     | Activates immediately; pre-authorized \$75M fund                   |
| <b>Political Sub-Track</b>       | Long-term Israel-Lebanon stability; UN Resolution 1701 implementation; maritime boundary demarcation | UN Special Coordinator (lead), Lebanon, Israel, US, France                               | Convenes at Day 60                                                 |
| <b>Economic Sub-Track</b>        | Reconstruction financing for southern Lebanon; energy infrastructure; port rehabilitation            | World Bank (lead), EU, Saudi Arabia, UAE, Iran (through proxy reconstruction fund)       | Convenes at Day 90; contingent on 60 days of verified border quiet |

### K.3.1 Iranian Participation

Iran participates as an observer state, not a full member. Iranian interests are represented by Oman (primary) and the UN Special Coordinator (secondary). Iran may fund reconstruction through the proxy reconstruction fund without direct engagement with Israeli officials. Framed domestically in Iran as "monitoring the situation to protect our allies" rather than "negotiating with the Zionist entity."

### **K.3.2 Israeli Participation**

Israel participates as a full member of the Steering Committee with: (1) full voting rights; (2) veto authority over any reconstruction funding that could be diverted to Hezbollah military purposes; (3) the right to suspend its participation without affecting Core Frame Part I; (4) the Tel Aviv Channel for bilateral US-Israel coordination.

### **K.3.3 Graduation Pathway**

If the Levant Regional Basket achieves 180 consecutive days of verified border quiet, it may graduate to a standalone Israel-Lebanon Framework Agreement brokered by the UN. Core Frame Part I does not depend on this graduation — the two frameworks operate on fully independent timelines.

## **K.4 Narrative Architecture for Lebanon**

### **US TALKING POINTS**

"The core US-Iran agreement addresses nuclear proliferation and freedom of navigation — America's core national security interests. Lebanon is a separate file managed through a dedicated regional basket with full Israeli participation. We are not trading Hormuz for Hezbollah. The Dossier Isolation Firewall ensures that what happens in Lebanon cannot affect the nuclear deal."

### **IRANIAN TALKING POINTS**

"The framework ends the war on all fronts. Through the Levant Regional Basket, Iran ensures that our allies in Lebanon are not abandoned while the main agreement proceeds. The Dossier Isolation clause protects the core agreement from being undermined by localized incidents. Iran's observer status allows us to monitor and protect Lebanese interests without direct engagement."

### **ISRAELI TALKING POINTS**

"Israel's security is not negotiable. The Levant Regional Basket is a separate diplomatic process in which Israel has full participation and veto authority. The core US-Iran agreement does not constrain Israel's right to self-defense. If Hezbollah attacks, Israel will respond — and the nuclear deal remains unaffected."

## LEBANESE TALKING POINTS

"Lebanon welcomes the Levant Regional Basket as a pathway to stability for our southern border. We are not a proxy battlefield. The Basket's humanitarian sub-track addresses the urgent needs of our civilian population. Lebanon's sovereignty is respected through our chairmanship of the Steering Committee."

## K.5 Summary: The Lebanon Bridge

The Lebanon annex bridges the fundamental disagreement between Iran (which demands an end to the war on all fronts) and the US/Israel (which want Lebanon kept separate). It does so by: (1) creating a structured Hezbollah operational pause that gives Israel immediate security benefits; (2) building an absolute firewall that prevents Lebanon incidents from collapsing the core deal; (3) establishing a parallel regional basket that addresses Lebanon on its own timeline with its own participants; and (4) providing each side with narrative frames that allow them to claim the outcome they need. Iran can say the war ends on all fronts. The US can say Lebanon is a separate track. Israel can say its security is protected. And the Dossier Isolation Firewall — now reinforced by the Dual-Key Escalation Lock — ensures that if any of these claims prove hollow, the Core Frame survives.

# Version 3.1 Changelog

Table 12: Version History

| Version | Date       | Changes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.0     | Early 2026 | Initial Crescent Compact — Core Frame (Parts I-III), Progressive Arches (Parts IV-VIII), 8 Annexes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 1.1     | March 2026 | FURC 18-month stability lock; Fissile Material Custody two-tranche architecture; Tiered Tolling; WBI system; eight Contingency Protocols                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 1.2     | March 2026 | SIWST Confiscation Protocol; CIVIR independent verification; Geographic Dispersion Limits; 5-Year Re-Arming Clawback; differentiated Rapid Panel timelines; Blue Line post-flight notification; Facility Perimeter Buffer Rule; Tier 4 Premium Security Transit                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 1.3     | April 2026 | Five Modular Verification Systems (CEMS, ASPAN, ZKPEV, APRM, CRYPTO); Political Circuit Breaker; Incentive Acceleration Mechanism; Annual Calibration Summit                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 1.4     | April 2026 | Missile CBDE Pilot; Consolidated Material Breach Definition (G.8); JCC Voting Authority Matrix (G.9)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1.5     | April 2026 | Goodwill Credit; Ambassador's Override; 48-Month Sunset of Automation; Ghajar 5-Year Cooling-Off; DAP; Diplomatic Innovation Fund (DIF); Strategic Narrative Protocol (Annex J)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 1.6     | April 2026 | Hezbollah Formal Political Party Rights; PLC Recognition Module; HTS Al-Qaeda Veteran Registry; Referendum Neutrality Clause                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 1.7     | April 2026 | FURP Presidential Policy Directive architecture; CNOC Simplified Framework; Iranian Sovereign Right Affirmation; Narrative Sovereignty Clause; Targeted Individual Sanctions Snap-Forward; Congressional Continuity Shield; Cyber Non-Escalation Protocol; Direct Military-to-Military Deconfliction Lines; Blue Line Demarcation Roadmap; UNIFIL Mandate Modernization; Israeli Self-Defense Carve-Out; Modular Ratification Pathways; Supreme National Interest Waiver; Shadow Compliance Channel; Quiet Diplomacy Channel; Joint Legal Interpretation Panel; Partial Automation-to-Recommendation Conversion; Phased Complexity Activation; 90-Day Early-Cycle Stabilization Window; Saudi-Iran Bilateral Stabilization Annex; Iraq Sovereignty Guarantee; Interpretive Buffer Zones |

|     |               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3.1 | Late May 2026 | Four surgical refinements for Sunday 4:00 PM Eastern deadline: (1) <b>IMCA Sovereignty Recalibration</b> (I-8.1-I-8.4) — explicit mandate restriction to 3 functions, PGSA recognized as sole coastal enforcement within Iranian territorial waters, PGSA-IMCA Interface Protocol, Optical Compromise Architecture; (2) <b>Automated Day 7 Dual-Trigger</b> (I-8.5) — 5-step technical architecture preventing front-loaded concessions; (3) <b>HEU Phase 1 Baseline</b> (I-2.1-I-2.4) — legal ownership (CBI) decoupled from physical custody (IAEA), disposition deferred to 30-60 day nuclear window, six-pathway menu; (4) <b>Lebanon Dossier Isolation Firewall</b> (Annex K) — Proxy Operational Pause across 3 phases, Dossier Isolation Firewall with 5 trigger categories, Levant Regional Basket with 5 elements, narrative architecture for 4 audiences. Updated preamble, I-8, and V-2 with v3.1 callouts. |
| 3.1 | Late May 2026 | <b>Lebanon "Dual-Key" Escalation Lock</b> (Annex K.2.2) — The Final Firewall. Adds explicit escalation ceiling provision: Hezbollah-originated attacks causing 25+ civilian fatalities in Israel do not trigger Core Accord step-back or sanctions snapback unless the UN Security Council determines within 72 hours that the attack was conducted pursuant to a direct, verifiable order from the Supreme Leader of Iran. Gives Israel immediate military response rights; gives Tehran an absolute legal shield. Makes the "rogue commander" or "false flag" scenario the only path to escalation.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

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### v3.1 Design Principles

These four surgical refinements were designed to meet four specific pushback points identified in the late May 2026 negotiation environment:

**IRGC/Fars News Agency pushback:** The sovereignty recalibration explicitly restricts IMCA to commercial coordination and recognizes PGSA as sole coastal enforcement — addressing the IRGC's concern that the multilateral maritime authority would erode Iranian sovereignty.

**Trump/Rubio "HEU must leave Iranian soil":** The Phase 1 baseline places HEU under IAEA physical custody immediately (satisfying the physical verification demand) while deferring final disposition to a negotiated window (preserving Iranian negotiating leverage on the nuclear file).

**Trump "no front-loaded concessions":** The automated Day 7 dual-trigger guarantees simultaneous execution within 60 seconds — neither side moves first, eliminating the sequencing trap that collapsed prior negotiations.

**Baghaei "end the war on all fronts including Lebanon":** The Lebanon annex provides Iran with a structural mechanism to address Lebanon without making the core deal conditional on Hezbollah compliance. The Dossier Isolation Firewall ensures that even if Lebanon deteriorates, the nuclear deal survives. The Dual-Key Escalation Lock now provides the final circuit breaker that makes the firewall truly impregnable.

*"The crescent does not illuminate all at once. It grows."*

The Crescent Compact v3.1 | Late May 2026 | Authorized Negotiators Only